

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 968

By Vital

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Troy Wayne Poteete.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly were greatly saddened to learn of the passing of Troy Wayne Poteete, whose life of public service and cultural stewardship left an indelible mark upon the Cherokee Nation; and

WHEREAS, born in 1955, Mr. Poteete dedicated his life to the service of his people and the preservation of Cherokee history and heritage; and

WHEREAS, Troy Poteete served with distinction as a member of the Cherokee Nation Tribal Council from 1991 to 1999, helping to shape legislative policy during a pivotal era of growth for the tribe; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Poteete's steadfast dedication to the Cherokee Nation continued when he was appointed as a Justice of the Cherokee Nation Supreme Court in 2007, and he further served as Director of the Arkansas Riverbed Authority; and

WHEREAS, widely recognized for wearing his distinctive traditional turbans in homage to his ancestors, Troy Poteete honored the enduring traditions and cultural identity of the Cherokee people; and

WHEREAS, as a founding member and Executive Director of the National Trail of Tears Association, he worked tirelessly to enhance public knowledge of the Trail of Tears, ensuring that this chapter of history would never be forgotten and helping to preserve historic sites and deepen understanding of its lasting impact; and

WHEREAS, Cherokee Nation Principal Chief Chuck Hoskin, Jr., aptly observed, "Troy Wayne's passing represents a significant loss of institutional knowledge and cultural passion. Today we take pause and honor his legacy of leadership and life's work."; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should pause to remember the bountiful life of this exceptional public servant and human being; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of Troy Wayne Poteete, reflecting with gratitude upon his life of service and his stalwart commitment to living the examined life with courage and conviction.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we express our sympathy and offer our condolences to the family of Mr. Poteete.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.